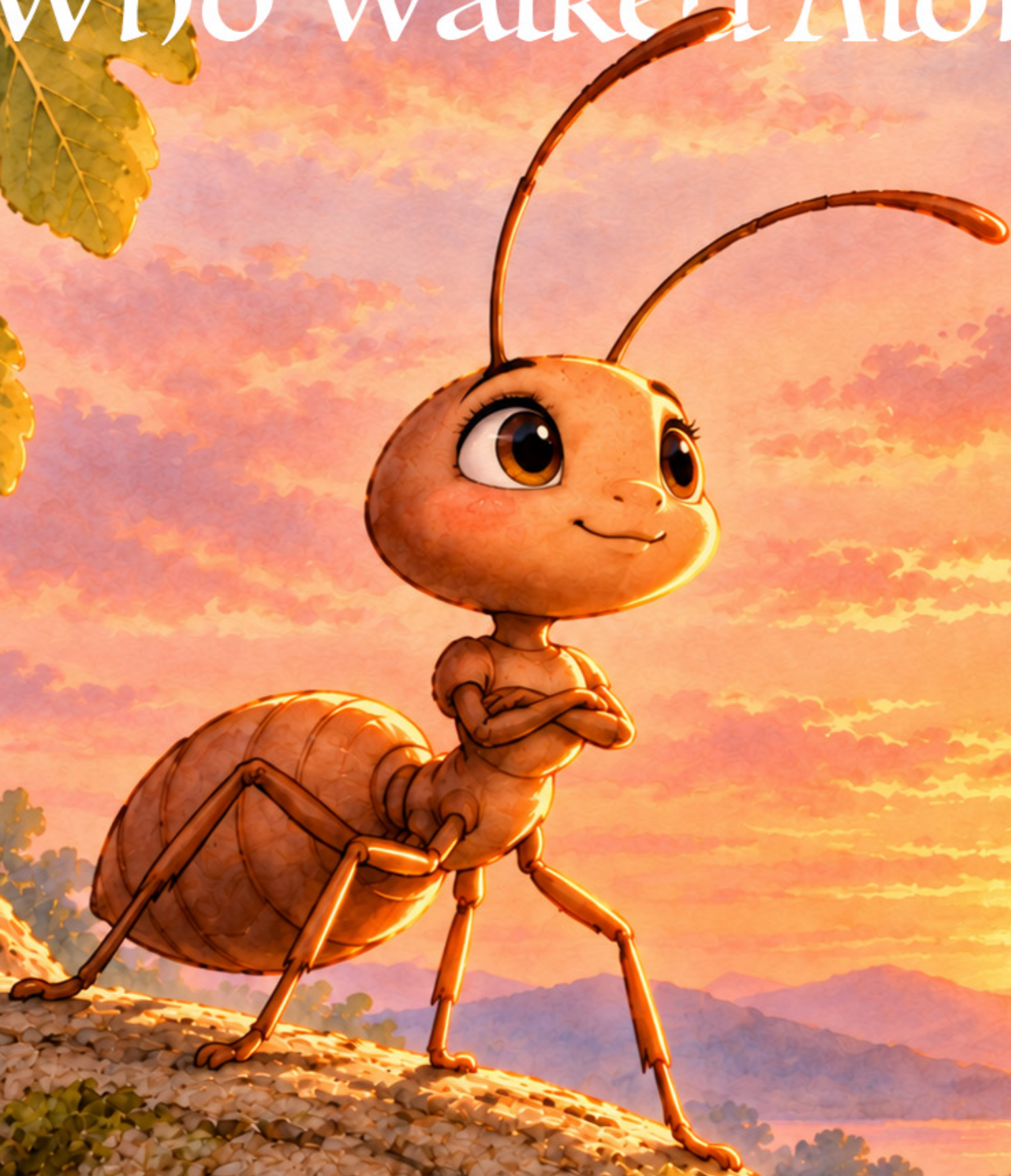


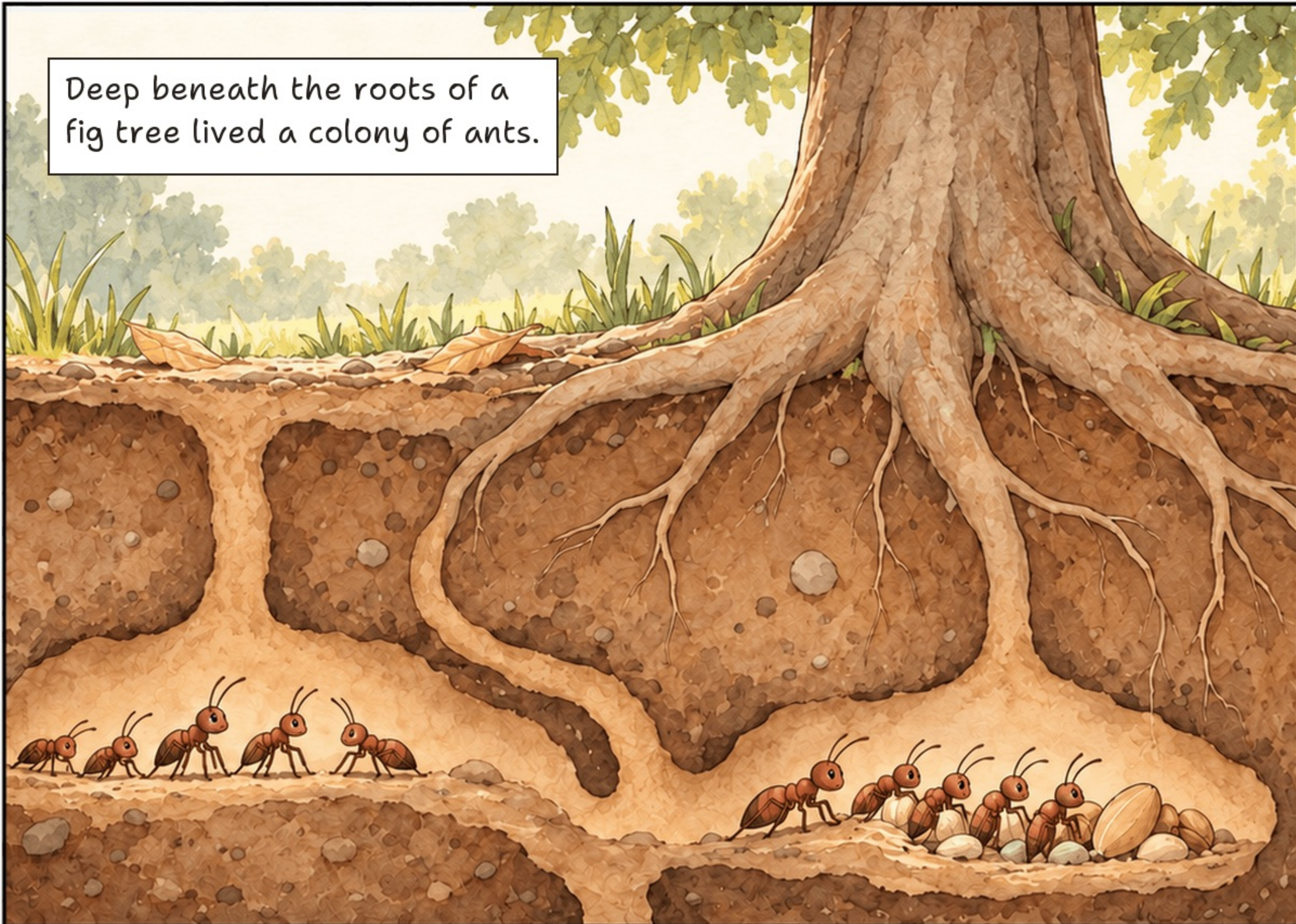
The Ant Who Walked Alone



Written by: Roi Werner

Created with Kav - <https://github.com/oraboy/kav>

Deep beneath the roots of a fig tree lived a colony of ants.



She was an ant
like any other.



She had a job. And a trail to follow.



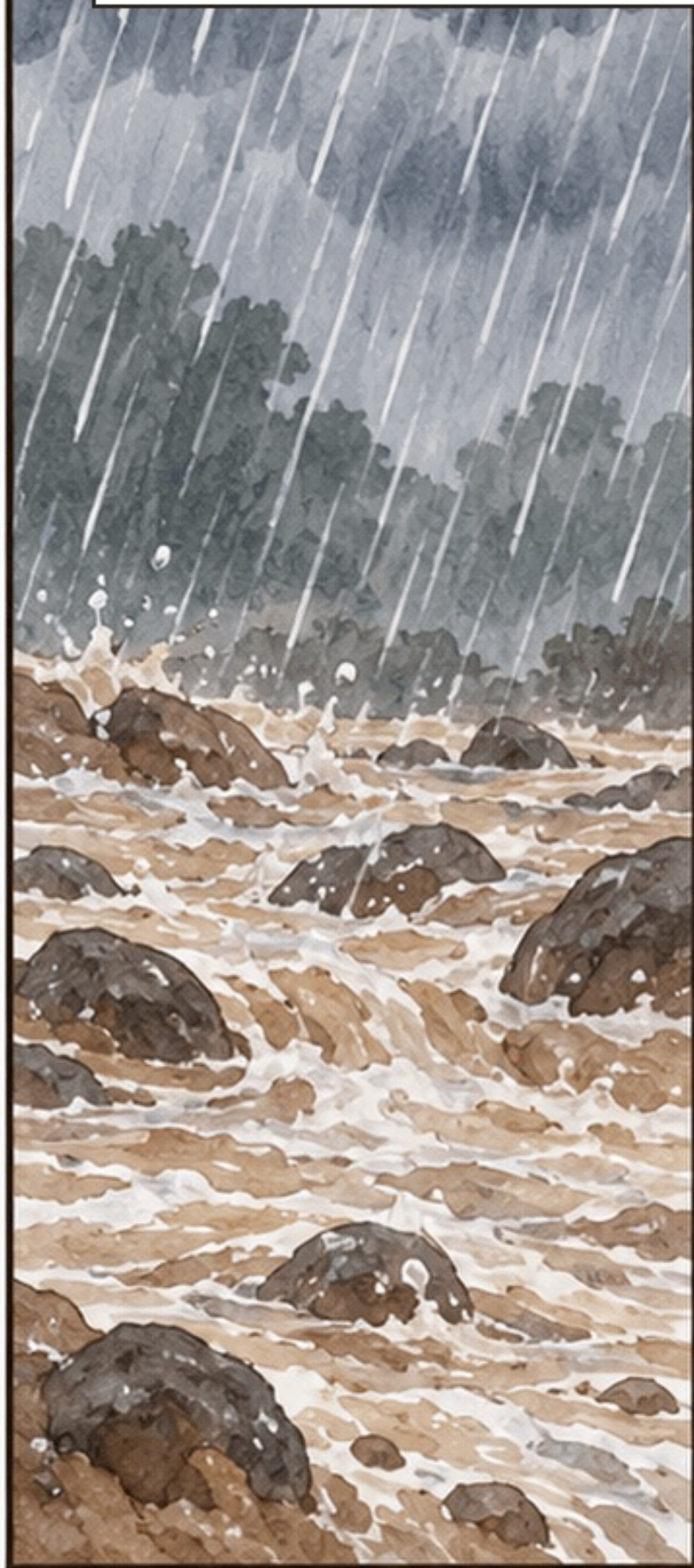
She carried what she was told to carry,
and went where she was told to go.



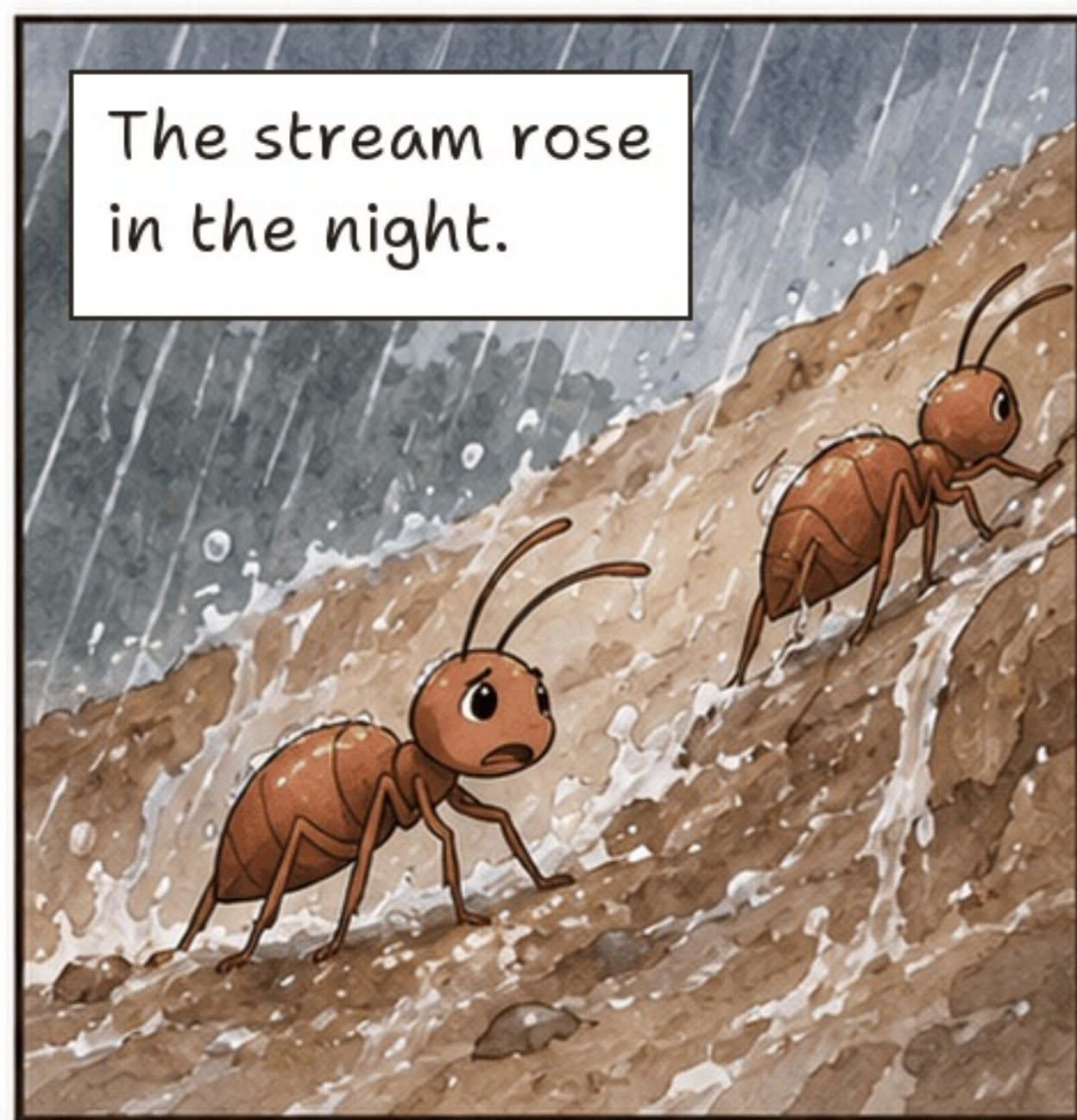
Always following the old familiar trails.



Then one summer, the rains came heavier than anyone could remember.



The stream rose in the night.



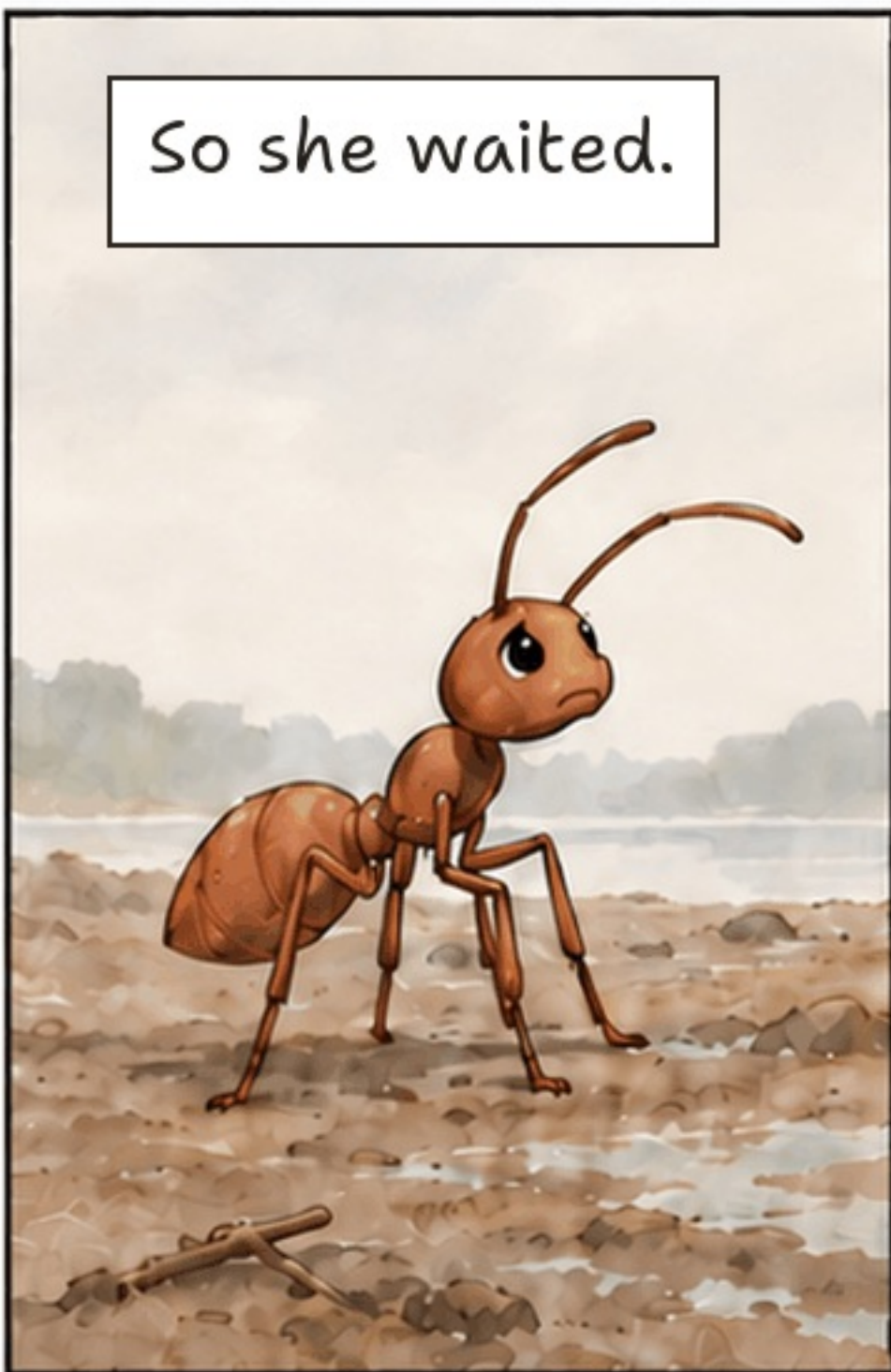
Dissolving the trails.



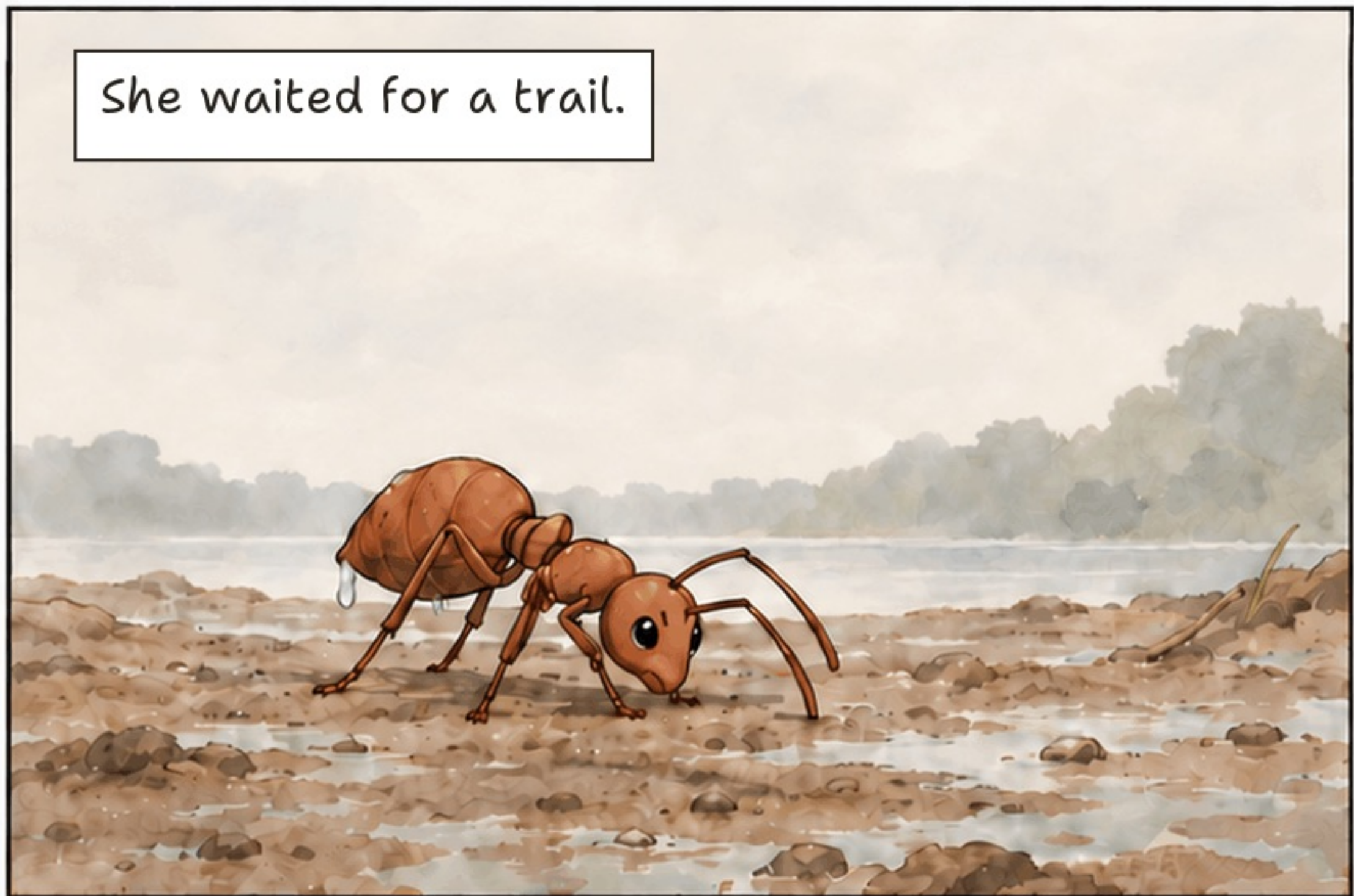
Eventually she found
dry ground.



So she waited.



She waited for a trail.



She waited for a sister to tell
her where to go or what to do.



But the rain had washed
everything clean.

There was only her, on a muddy bank she didn't recognize.



It wasn't that she was never alone before, she was sent on errands and chores, but she was never in a place where she didn't know what to do.

So she did the
only thing left
to do.



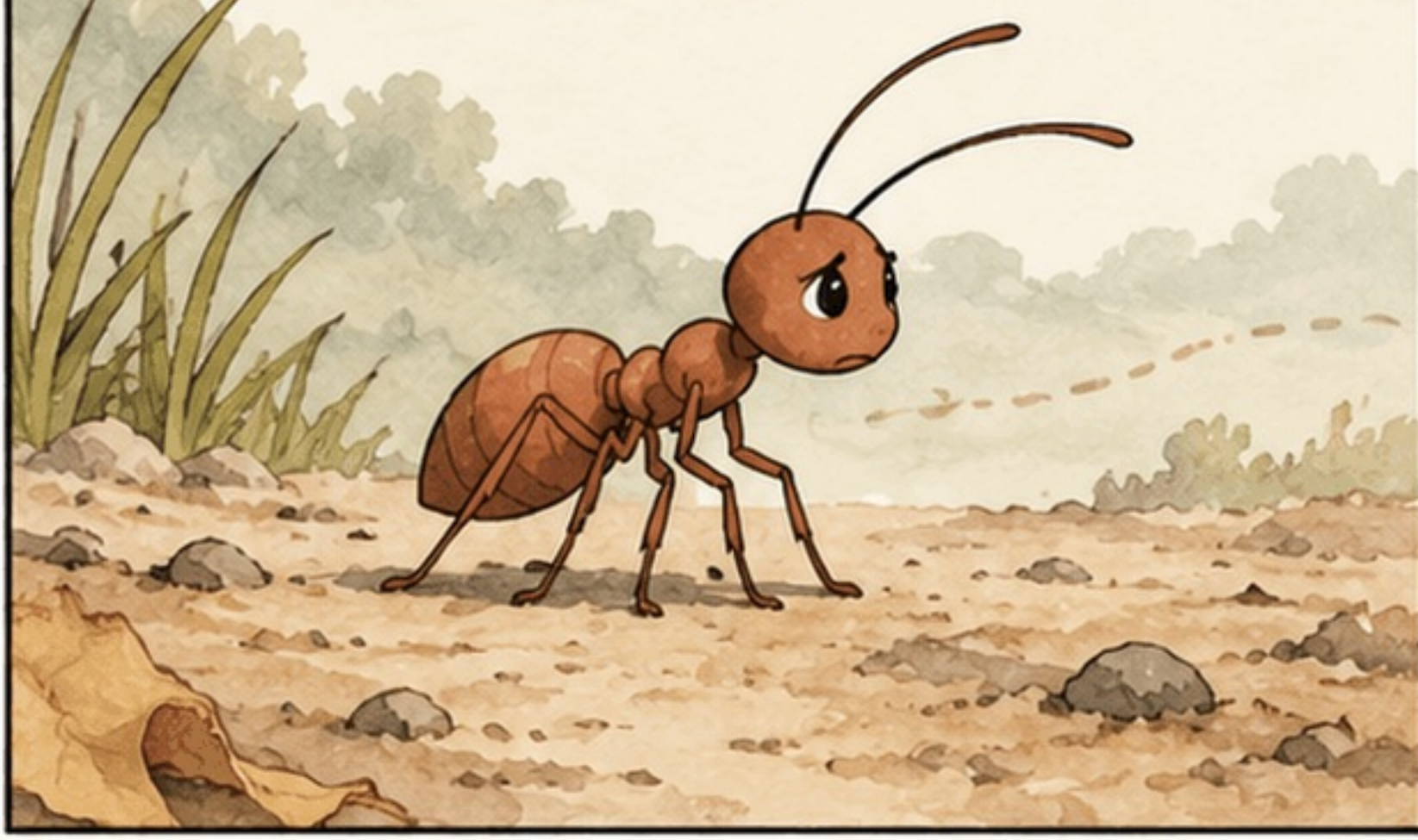
She walked.



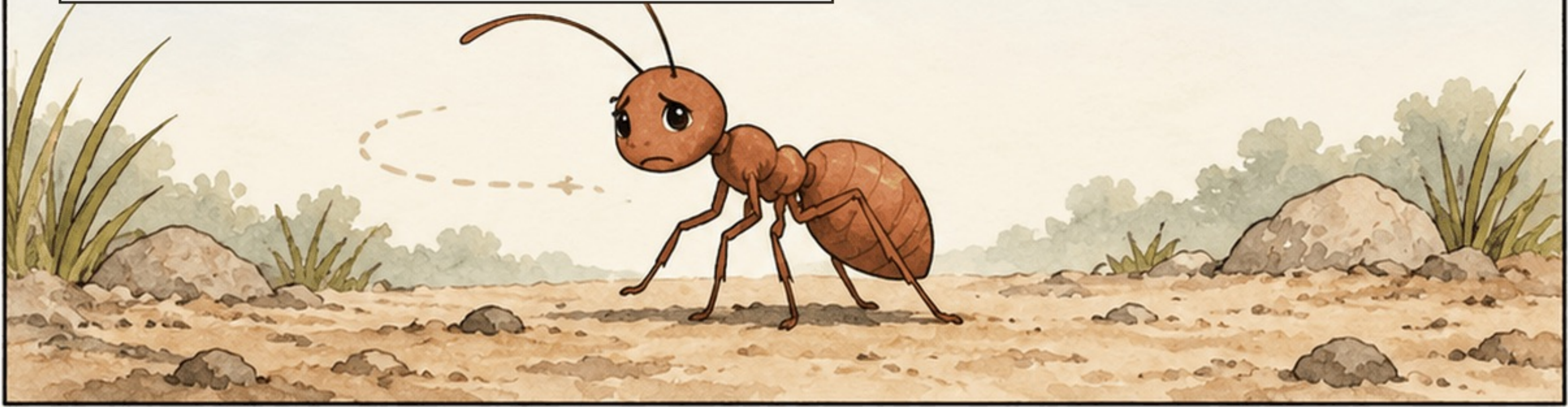
Every choice was hers now.



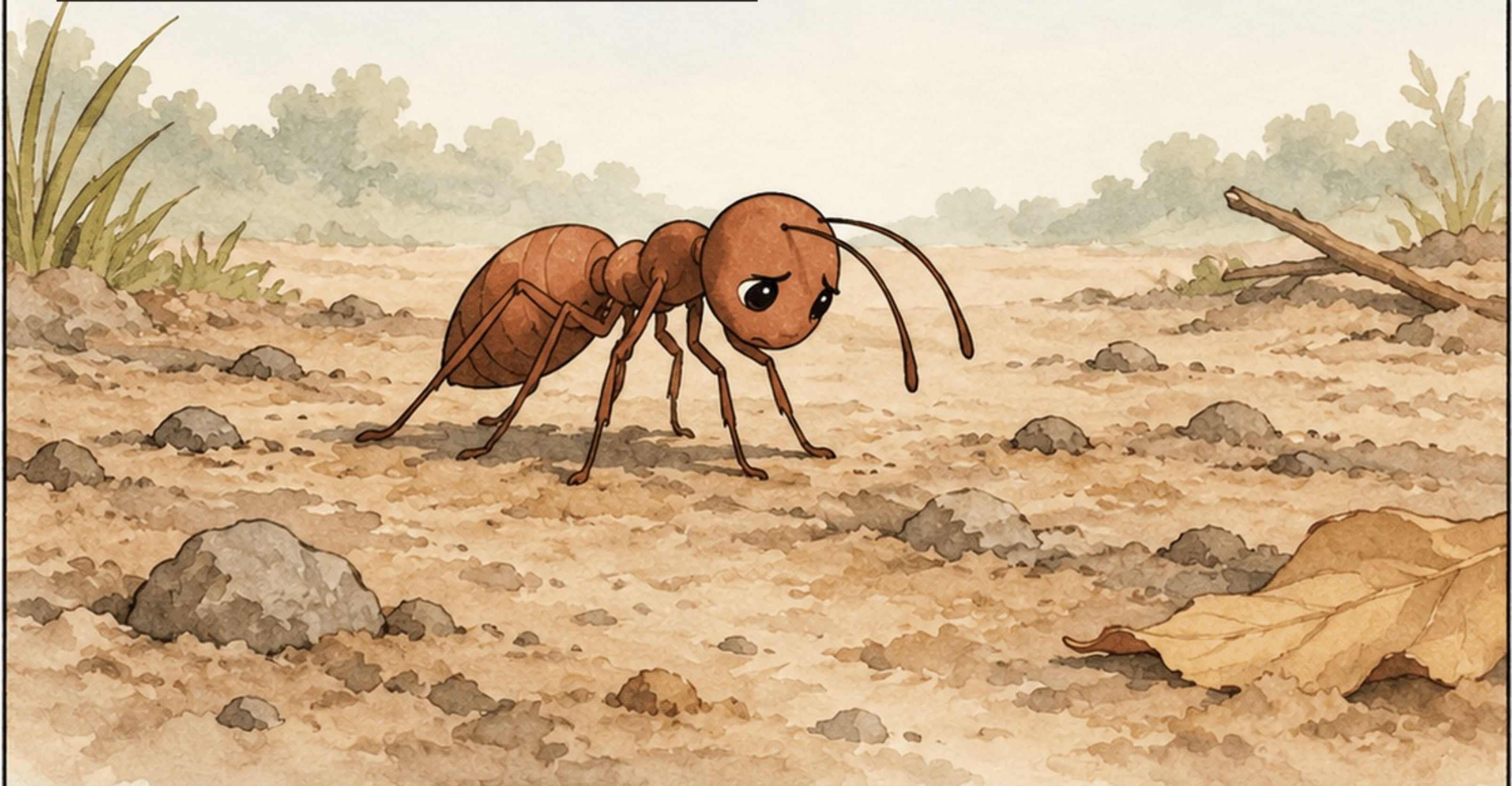
Not every choice
was the right one.



A scent led nowhere. She turned back.



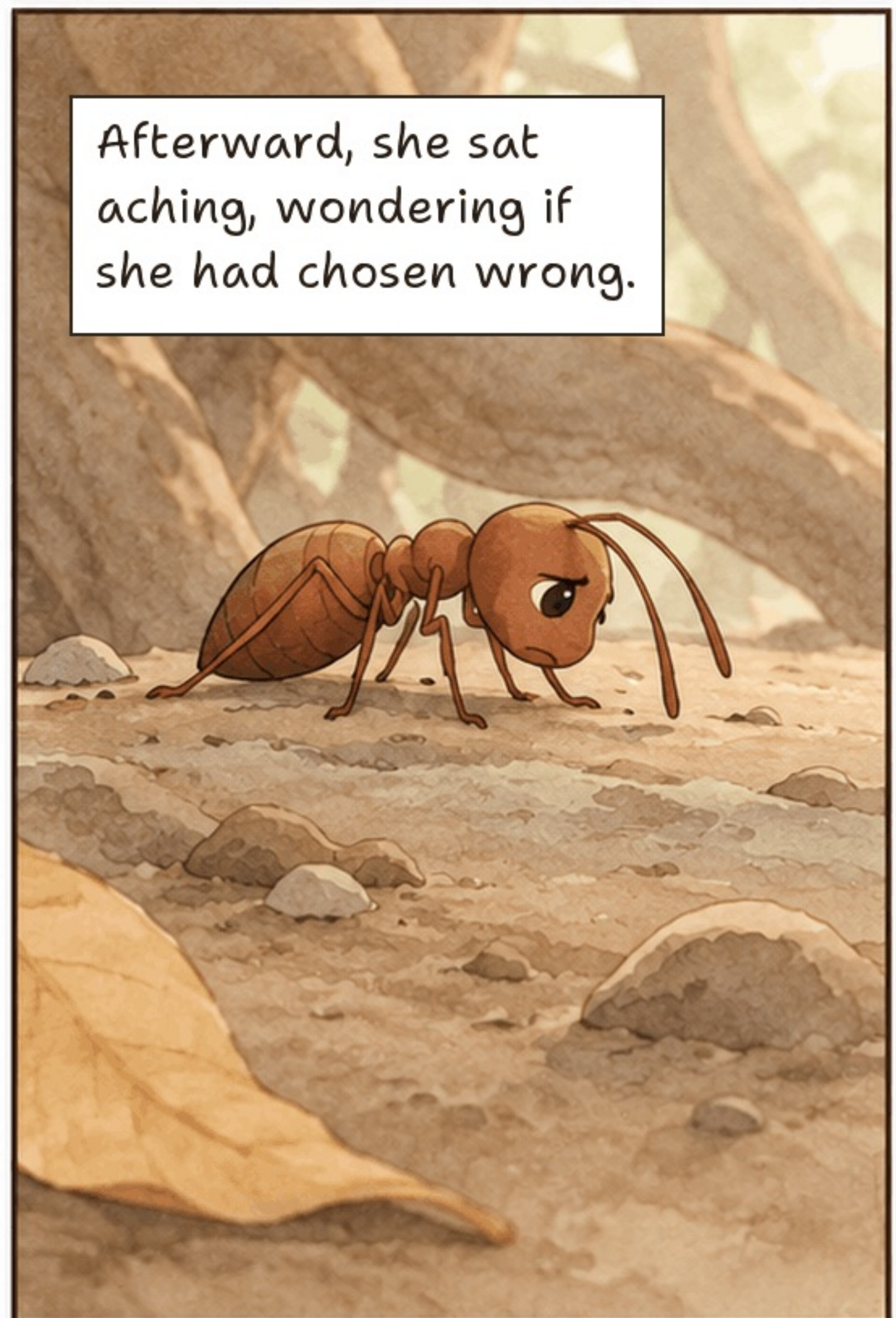
For a day, she found nothing to eat.



The roots scraped
and tired her.



Afterward, she sat
aching, wondering if
she had chosen wrong.



But she kept going.



Beneath a curled leaf, she found shelter.



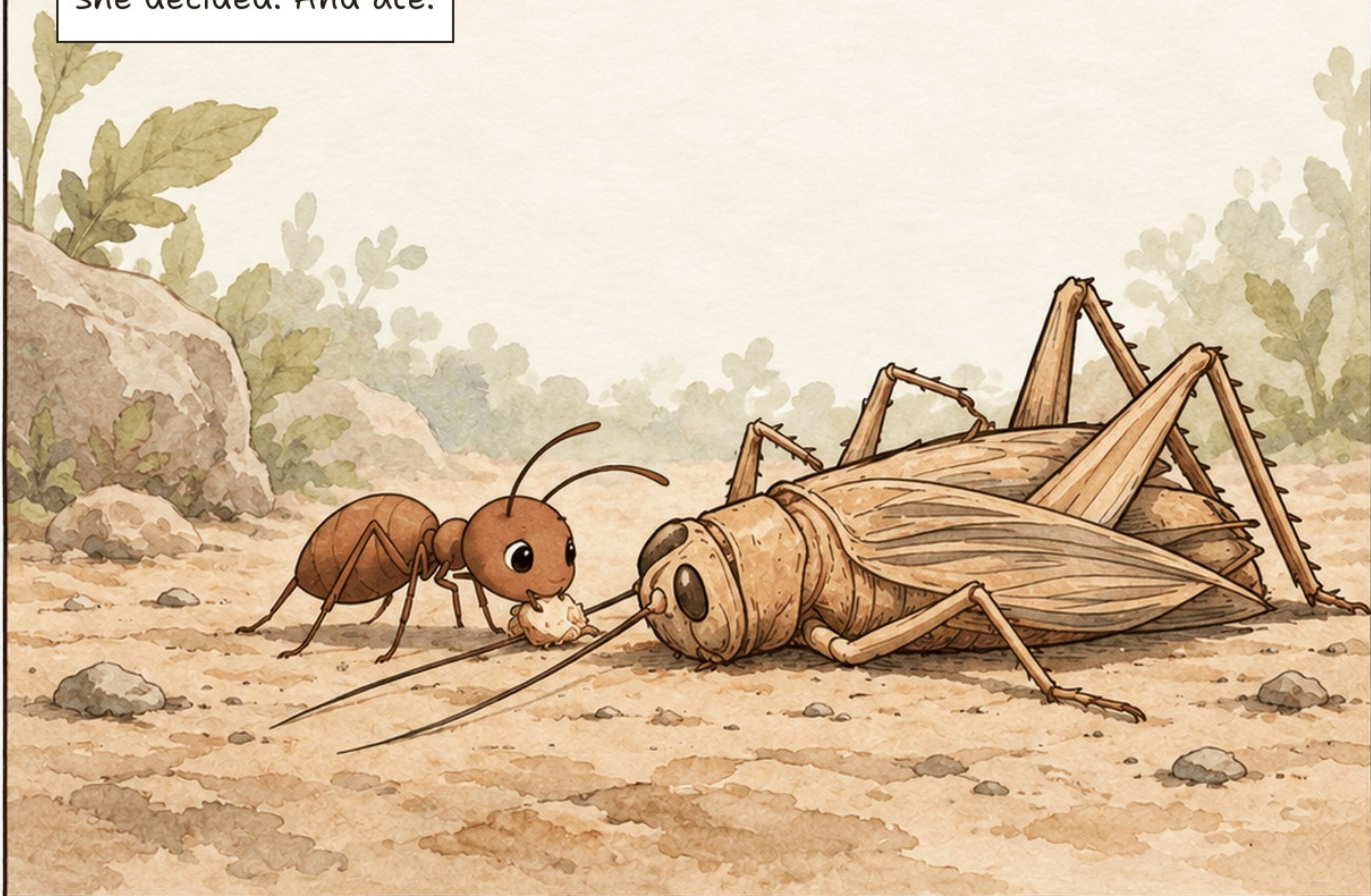
She followed a scent
to a dead cricket.



No one told her it was food.



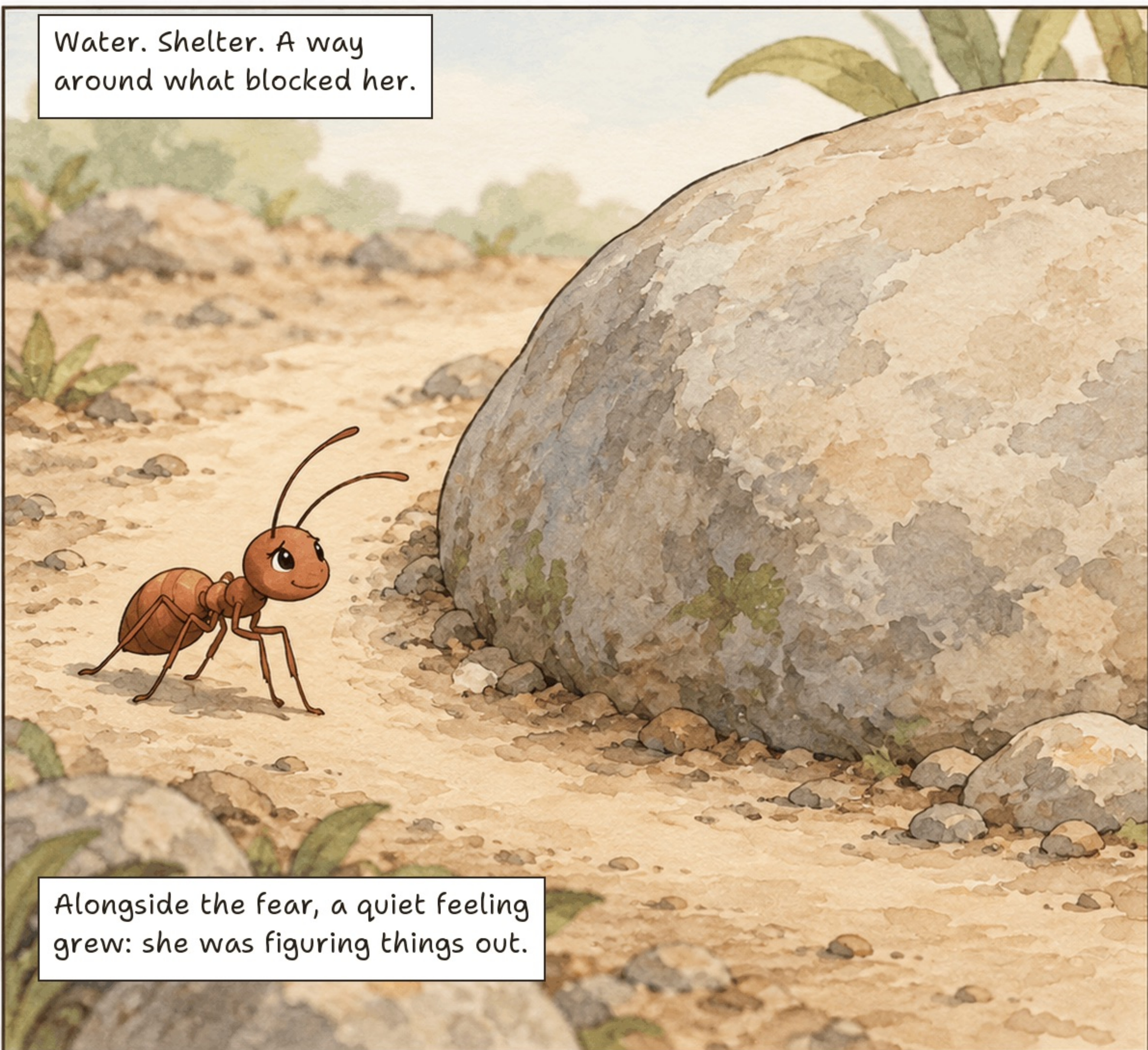
She decided. And ate.



Days passed.



Water. Shelter. A way
around what blocked her.

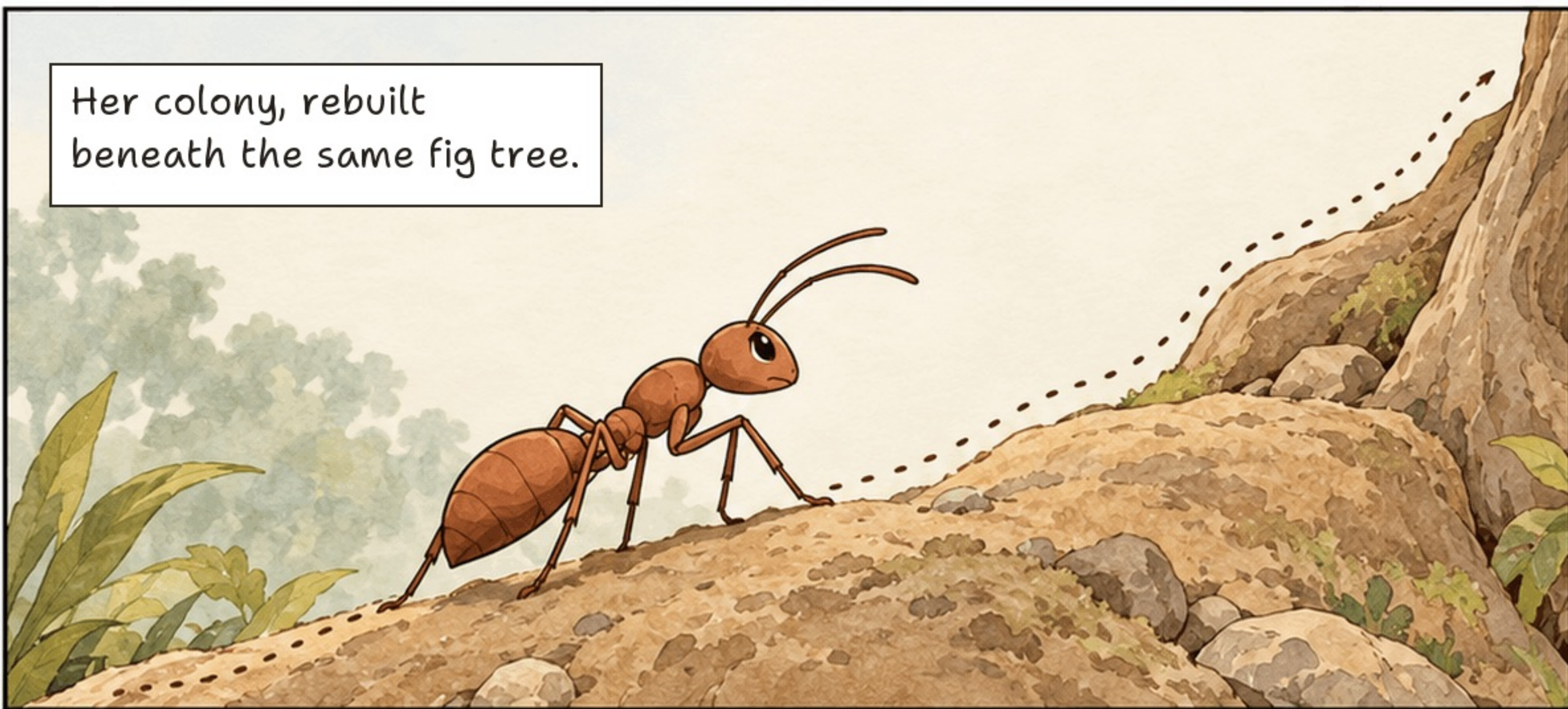


Alongside the fear, a quiet feeling
grew: she was figuring things out.

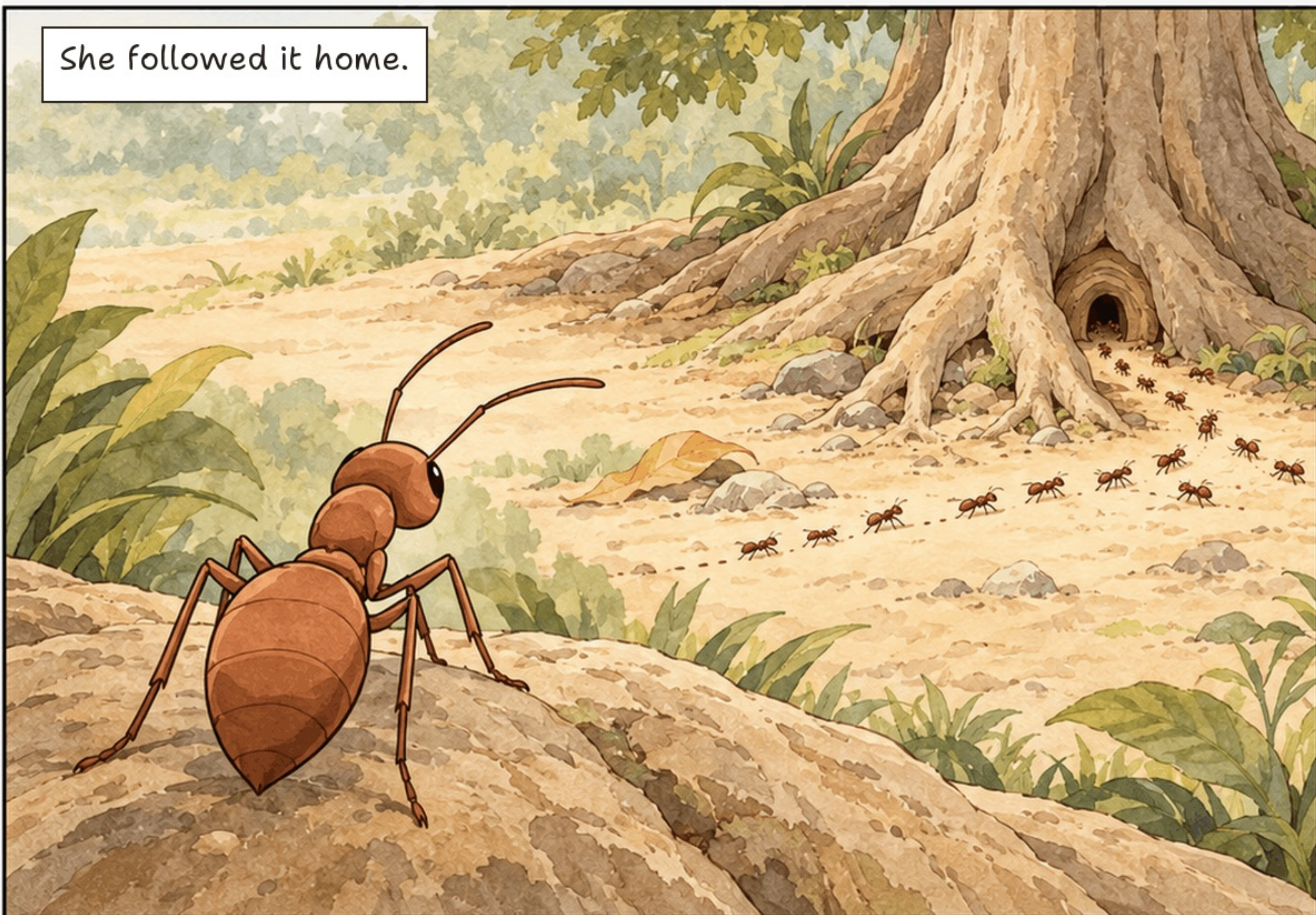
On the ninth day, she
caught a scent she knew.

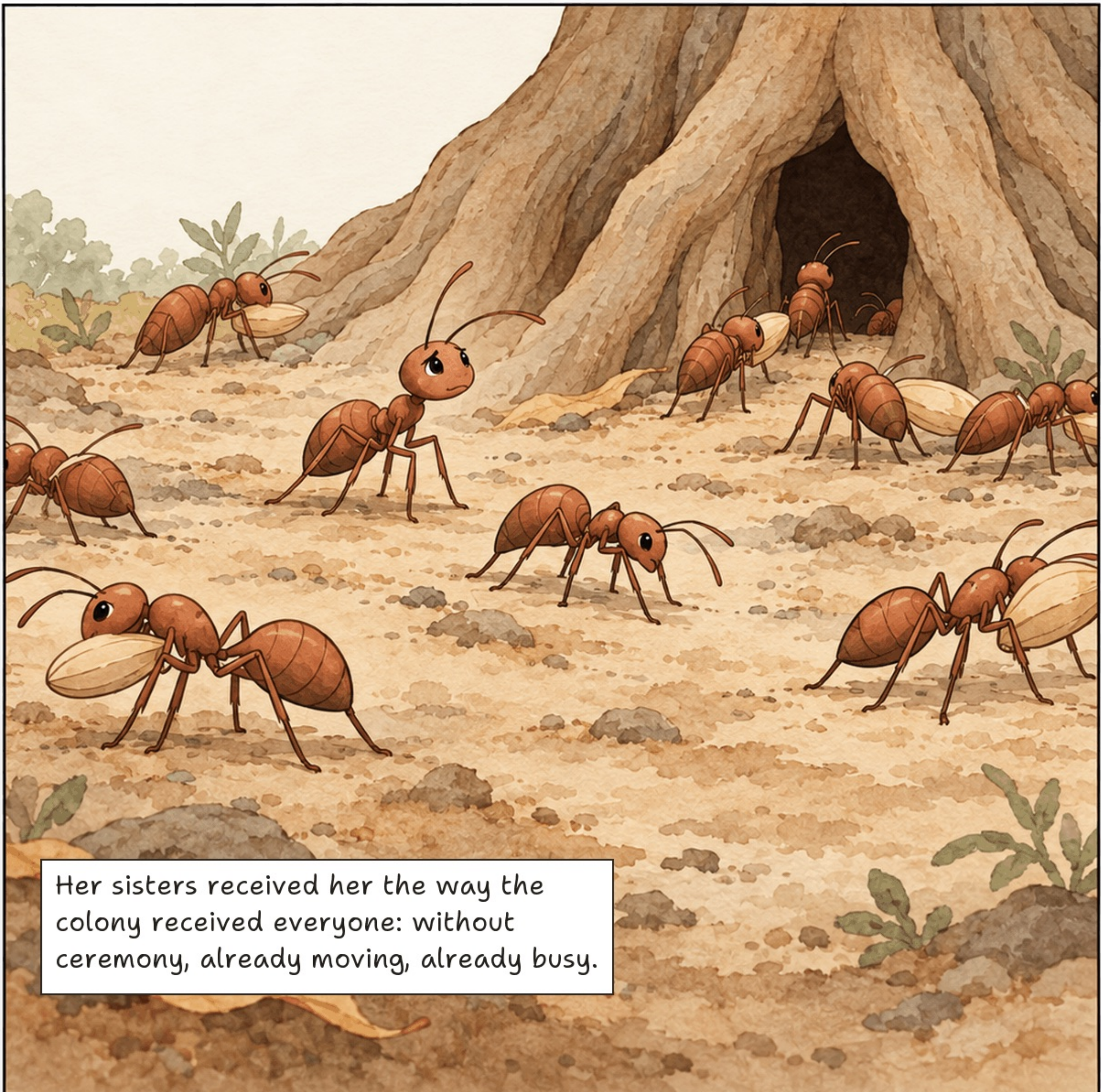


Her colony, rebuilt
beneath the same fig tree.



She followed it home.





Her sisters received her the way the colony received everyone: without ceremony, already moving, already busy.

Soon, she had a task again.



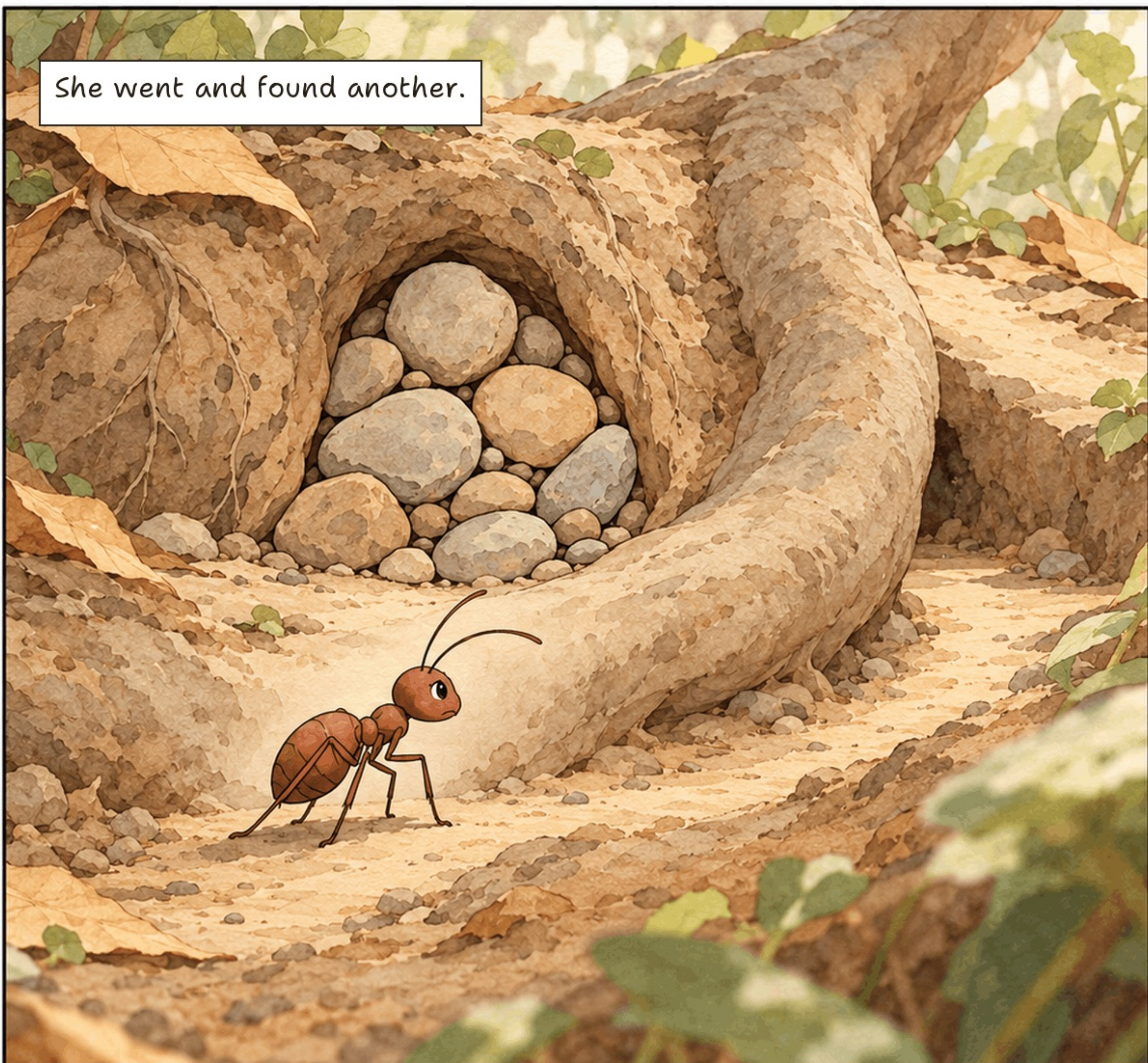
But something in her had changed.



When the old path was blocked, she didn't wait for a new trail.



She went and found another.



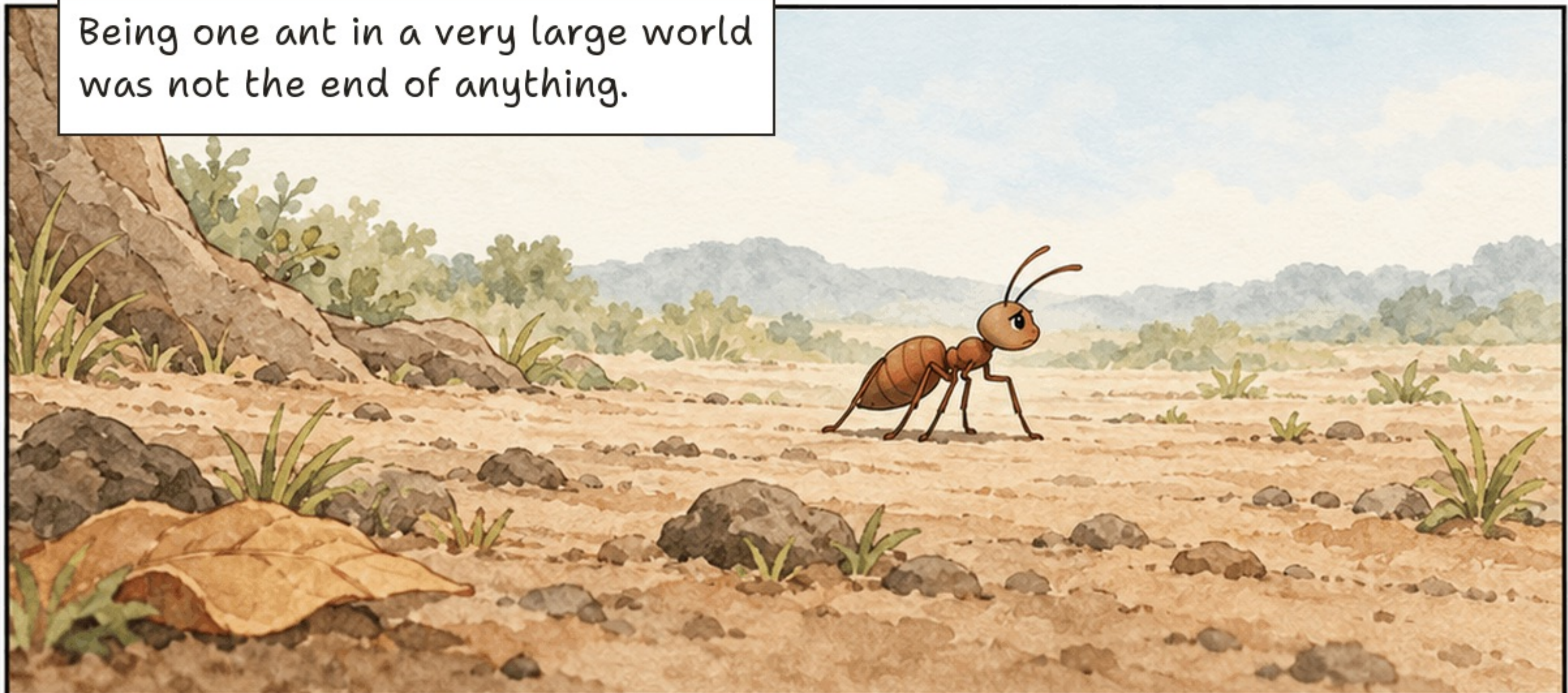
When a scout went missing,
she went out to search.



Alone.



Being one ant in a very large world
was not the end of anything.



She never told the story.

But she carried it with her.



Because knowing it was enough.